

## FUTURISTIC GADGETS

## XYZ da Vinci Mini

**T**he XYZ da Vinci Mini is a capable 3D printer aimed towards casual customers. The printer is priced at \$199.95 (roughly ₹13,600), a competitive, affordable price in this category. It offers a lot of printing capabilities in accordance with the cost, however, there are a few drawbacks. The da Vinci Mini is only compatible with XYZ filaments, compromising versatility by being able to use third-party filaments, and printing at the highest quality is extremely slow. The XYZ filaments aren't too expensive though, priced at \$27.99 per reel, which is on par with other filaments and also comes with a wide range of colours that can be chosen. The filaments also sport an NFC tag which tracks the amount of colour and PLA print filament used. The print



bed is a 6x6-inch aluminium slab that is covered with a thin sheet of tape which the PLA filament sticks to. The printer certainly stands out from the crowd with its bright orange plastic case, in a sea of black 3D printers. The 3D printer has no controls on the device itself, but instead it has all of them of the XYZware program, available for free on Windows or Mac.



## MARS Earbuds

**T**he MARS Earbuds were revealed at CES 2018, claiming that they could accomplish what Pixel Buds couldn't. The earbuds sport bud-to-bud translation like the Bragi Dash Pro and the Pixel Buds. However, they excel at an avenue where the others fail. The MARS Earbuds allow you to hand over one bud to the person you are speaking to and you can start having a conversation with the person speaking a different language. The buds will need to be connected to a smartphone, since all the processing is done on the cloud. You will not need to pull out your phone as long as you have the languages preset. The MARS buds eliminate the hassle of one person having to speak to a smartphone. The Bragi Dash supports bud-to-bud conversation but, as we said, both participants need to have a pair of earbuds to avail this function. The MARS Earbuds sets itself apart because of the ability to pass over one of the earbuds and single press of a button will start transmitting airwaves, aiding your conversation. The earbuds work on all Android and iOS devices and currently support four languages- English, Korean, Chinese and Japanese. The company looks forward to possibly partner with Google and Siri to gain access to a vast variety of languages.

## Vaonis Stellina

**T**he Vaonis Stellina is a smart telescope on geared to bring astronomy to the general public. Cyril Dupus, CEO of Vaonis, stated, "The goal of this project is to make astronomy accessible to everyone". The Stellina delivers on this front by offering a simple, more user-friendly method to gaze at the stars instead of the complicated installation processes of other telescopes. However, the feature that attracts the most attention in this ethereal piece of technology is that it can be connected to our phones wirelessly and use the smartphone's GPS to locate any celestial bodies, be it a cluster of stars or individual planets. The device costs \$3000 (approximately ₹2,00,00) and the official worldwide launch is imminent. However, you can reserve yours on their official website. The telescope connects to our smartphones via an app which is available of the App Store and is coming soon to the Play Store. You can easily snap pictures of gorgeous stars and planets by setting up the tripod, pressing the power button and then choosing from an array of celestial



bodies suggested by the mobile app. The Stellina processes the information speedily and positions itself, takes a pictures and directly transfers it to your smartphone or computer. The device is compact, lightweight and can easily be slipped into a backpack.